Catholic Women's League Aotearoa New Zealand

Working Together as One - Kia Mahi Tahi



Our Patron Saint

In 1558 the Elizabethan era saw a return to Protestantism and equally harsh penalties for disobedience with Catholics now on the receiving end. This was the world Margaret Clitherow grew up in. At the age of eighteen, she married butcher John Clitherow, a widower with two small sons. The family lived in his house the front room of which was the butchery – in the bustling Shambles in the centre of York.

It was around this time she started to explore Catholicism. After much soul searching during which she "found no substance, truth nor Christian comfort in the ministers of the new church, nor in their doctrine" she entered into the Catholic church.

Over the next few years Margaret continued to defy the authorities over non-attendance of services, which resulted in her spending time in prison, during which it's believed she gave birth to her third child, William. On her release she immediately arranged, along with some of her neighbours, to have Mass said at her home and give priests any protection needed.

Two years later in March 1586, a young Flemish boy, terrified by threats of a beating, told the authorities where the secret room, housing the chapel, was located. Margaret was arrested and taken to the Headquarters for questioning. When she refused to capitulate, she was thrown into a cell in the Castle prison. Margaret's fate had been sealed. Her husband and children were not allowed to see her so she died without ever setting eyes on them again.

On Friday the 25th of March 1586, Margaret Clitherow was taken to the Tolbooth on Ouse Bridge in York, where a small crowd awaited to witness her execution. On being told to confess that she died for treason, she answered that she died "for the love of my Lord Jesu."

She then lay on the floor. A stone was placed under her back, a heavy door laid on top of her and her arms stretched out and tied to two posts. Margaret's last words were "Jesu! Jesu! Jesu! have mercy on me!" She died 15 minutes later though her body lay there until midnight when it was removed and buried in a city rubbish dump. It took her friends several weeks to find it but when they did, they went to great lengths to keep secret the place where she was given a Catholic burial. Even today it's not known where Margaret Clitherow was laid to rest.

Saint Margaret Clitherow



In 1943 the Catholic Women's League chose her as their patroness and they began campaigning for her canonisation. It took until 1970 when St Margaret Clitherow became one of the 40 Martyrs of England and Wales. A multitude of CWL members attended the ceremony in Rome to see 27 years of prayers answered.

In 2008, the Bishop of Middlesborough unveiled a commemorative plaque on Ouse Bridge in York, the place of her death.

Her feast day is March 26th although she is also remembered on **August 30th** along with fellow martyrs St Anne Line and St Margaret Ward. The feast for the 40 Martyrs is **25th of October.**

Originally published in the Marist Messenger.abridged

History



The Catholic Women's League (CWL) was founded in England in 1906,
by **Miss Margaret Fletcher, (*see separate sheet)*** whose aim was to make Catholic women conscious of the contribution, based on the teaching of the Church, that they could make, to the **social, intellectual and spiritual life of the community.**

The Patron Saint of the CWL is Saint Margaret Clitherow. (see separate page)

In New Zealand, the CWL was first established in **Auckland in 1931**, by Bishop Liston who had as his ideal "The uniting of all Catholic women in New Zealand – a branch in every parish". A motto in keeping with the spirit of the League was chosen – "Faith and Service".

The first Maori Catholic Ladies League of Matamata was established also in **1931.**
In 1932 the first country branches were formed in **Rotorua, Tauranga and Whakatane.**

*Following the formation of the branches in the Auckland Diocese, **a one-day conference was held each year. A theme was chosen for discussion** and League matters were addressed. **Regional Representatives** became the basis of a Diocesan Council, attending monthly meetings which lead to great cooperation. This system still applies today. From 1934 to 1964, 61 branches had been formed.*

In 1976 it was reported that there were 2270 members in the 70 branches in the Auckland Diocese. In 1980 the Diocese was divided into two – Auckland and Hamilton. This left more manageable numbers and the count was then 1137 members in 37 branches.

Bishop of **Christchurch,** Bishop Brodie, saw the need for a women's organization. Initially, a Catholic Women's Club was inaugurated but then it was decided to become part of the Catholic Women's League. This took place in **1936,** the object being to unify the Catholic women in social, intellectual and charitable pursuits, under the direction of the Bishop. Bishop Brodie said: "This movement is worldwide and its universality should inspire enthusiasm amongst its members and ensure its success". The first branches in the Christchurch Diocese were: Akaroa, Ashburton, Timaru, Chatham Islands and Waimate. In 1976 there were 31 branches with a membership of 1368. In 1990 there were 26 branches of CWL in the Christchurch Diocese.

Wellington's League began with a Foundation Meeting in 1944

Bishop Whyte of Dunedin was anxious that the women of his flock should have the same advantage of support and friendship that those in northern centres were enjoying. Rev. Fr. Gavin chaired the **first meeting in 1949** which 300 ladies attended.

CWL Foundress

Margaret Fletcher,

FOUNDRESS of the Catholic Women's League, was born in Oxford, England, on 12 December 1862 and died in December, 1943 at the age of 81.





At 17 Margaret attended Slade School of Art in Chelsea. She continued her studies in Paris and met students of other nationalities, which gave her the opportunity for long discussions with them about life, religion and politics. She later returned to Oxford where she felt a strong urge to fight for improved educational opportunities for women. The suffrage movement had begun, but she saw many dangers in it. An avid reader, Margaret always searched for the Truth. The turning point came for her after reading the writings of St John of the Cross. Having sought the advice of a priest friend, she decided to become a Catholic, and was received into the Church on September 9, 1897. After this she took an active part in parish life and became friends with Mary Miller who had travelled widely in Europe doing research work on Catholic secondary education for girls. It was from Mary that Margaret learned about a new Catholic organization in Germany, established as an alternative to the secular National Council of Women.

Margaret's social action within the Church began with the launching of a quarterly called 'The Crucible'. This was aimed at rousing the interest of teachers and schools to get better social education for women. It ran for eight years and in one of its last issues came the proposal for a league of Catholic women.

This League became a reality In 1906 with Margaret Fletcher elected as its first president. She saw the League as the voice of Catholic women in the social questions of the time, supportive of the good in the feminist movement but opposed to its more radical demands. In the following years, the League movement grew throughout England and America, and, in 1910, twelve national Leagues formed the International Federation of Catholic Women's Leagues.



Margaret insisted that **CWL needed women with "balanced commonsense"**, and that they should **"utilise the average woman in convincing the Catholic world that business-like methods and intellectual gifts are excellent weapons in the service of God".**

CWLANZ National Board 2023

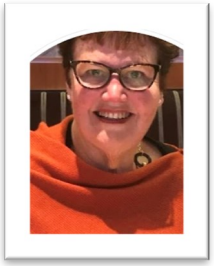




National President
Sylvia Mellish



National Secretary
Mary Slattery



National Treasurer
Colleen McKay



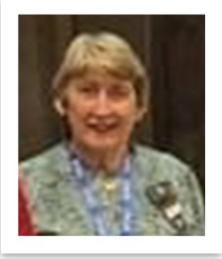
Imm Past President
Susan Dickson



Auckland Dio President
Fleur de Farias



National Board Chaplain
Christine Paterson



Hamilton Dio President
Moira Kilbride



Wellington Arch Dio President
Susan Lloyd



National Mission Secretary
Joan Lawn



International Secretary
Liz Roche



Social Issues Secretary
Bonnie Savage



Dunedin Dio President
Anne McRandle


Reflections

CWL Hymn

O Lord my God From near and distant regions
In bonds of love our hearts today unite
We offer Lord the work we've shared together
May all we do, bring favour in your sight

Refrain: *Then sings my soul my Saviour God to Thee*
How great thou art: How great Thou art
Then sings my soul my Saviour God to Thee
How great thou art; How great Thou art

As on the cross you still remembered Mary
Remember us the women of today
As we go forth to live in faith and service
go with us Lord and guide us on our way

Refrain

LITURGY FOR OUR BELOVED DECEASED

The five Diocesan Presidents of the National Board will each come forward and place a flower on the side altar and light a candle for members of their diocese who have gone to God over the past year, as their names are read out. President Susan will light a candle for those we have lost from our New Zealand members in previous years and for their families.

We pray together

Eternal and loving God, we, the members of the Catholic Women's League of Aotearoa New Zealand stand together in prayer for members from over all over New Zealand whose lives among us have now ended.



They worked generously to fulfill the mission of the League and live out its motto in faith and service. As they gave of the abundance of their love in life, we ask you now, O God, to draw them into the fullness of Your life and love so that they may live eternally in your peace and joy. Amen

We Sing ***Eternal rest grant to them O Lord***
and let perpetual light shine upon them
May they rest in peace, may they rest in peace.



Prayer for the Deceased

The following prayer may be prayed by League members at the funeral or vigil for the funeral of a fellow member.
(It is recommended that, if the family of the deceased agrees, members gather around the casket to pray this prayer)

(Banners, *Member's Branch and or Diocesan*, may be displayed discreetly near the altar
and the Diocesan Candle placed to the side of the altar.)

We Pray together

Eternal and loving God, we, the members of the Catholic Women's League of Aotearoa, New Zealand stand together in prayer for .....whose life among us has now ended.

.....worked generously to fulfill the mission of the League and live out its motto of 'Faith and Service'.

As she gave of the abundance of her love in life, we ask you now o God , to draw her to the fullness of Your life and love, so that she may live eternally in your peace and joy.

Amen

Catholic Women's League Prayer

- Come o Holy Spirit fill the hearts of your faithful and kindle in them the fire of your love. Send forth your spirit and they shall be created and you shall renew the face of the earth.

- Let us pray: O god who does teach the hearts of the faithful by the light of your holy sprit, grant that in the same spirit we may be always truly wise and ever rejoice in your consolation Through Christ our Lord. Amen

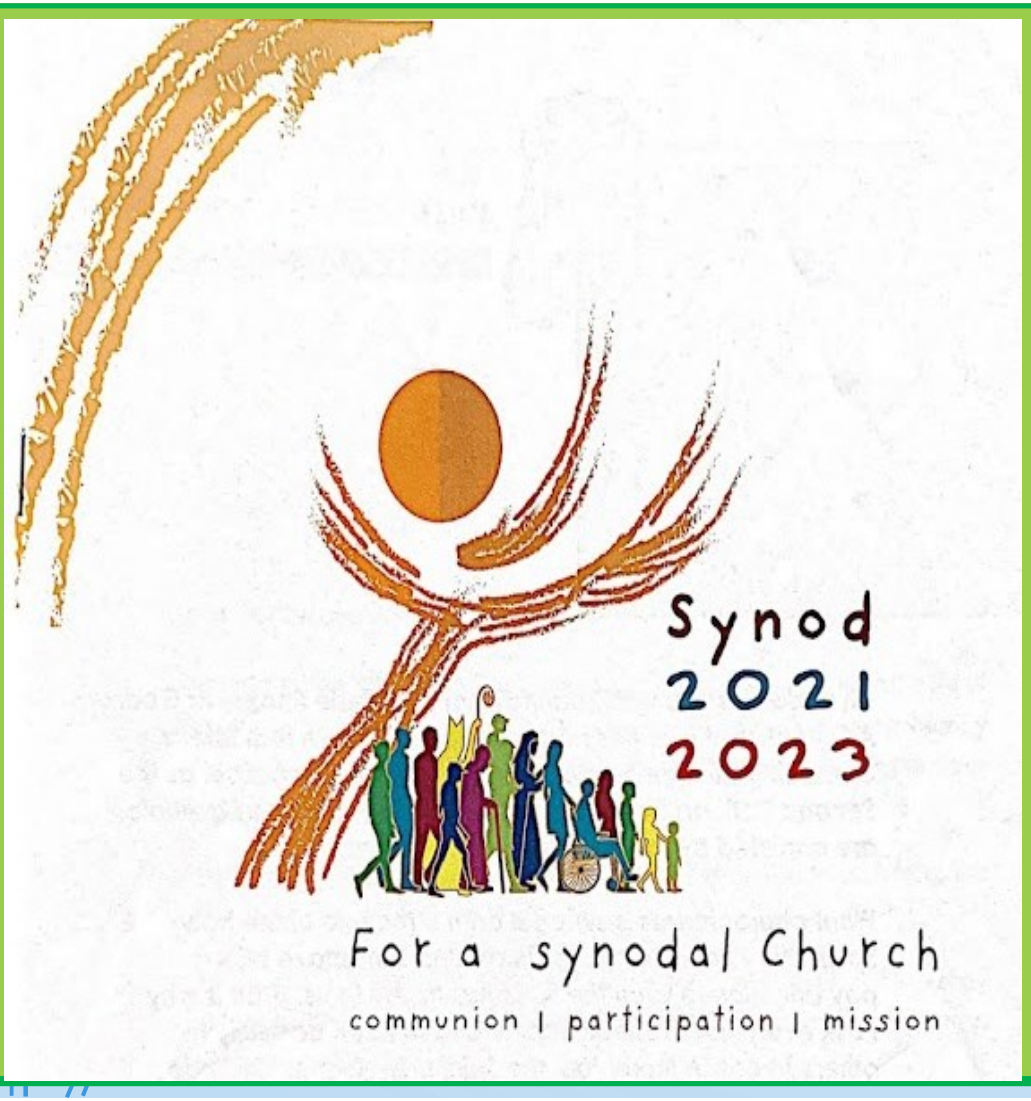
- Direct we beseech Thee O God, our actions by your holy inspirations that every prayer and work of ours will always begin from you and by you be happily ended. Through Christ Our lord. Amen

- Mary Mother of the Church Pray for us

- St Joseph pray for us

- St Margaret Clitherow pray for us

Updates on the Papal Synod





catholic diocese of christchurch
Bishop's Pastoral Office

World Union of Catholic Women's Organisations

Motto: "listening to transform lives".

In the early 1920's the International Federation of Catholic Women's Leagues changed its name to World Union of Catholic Women's Organisations (WUCWO) to embrace other types of Catholic women's groups. In 1928, WUCWO was given representation on the League of Nations which led, in 1945, to consultative status on various United Nations organizations. CWLANZ has been part of WUCWO since 1948 when Miss Kathleen O'Connor, first National President of CWLANZ, was invited onto the WUCWO Board. A National Special Officer, known as the International Secretary, liaises with WUCWO and branches celebrate the WUCWO World Day of Prayer in May each year. They also contribute to a special collection for the international work of WUCWO.

Affiliated Countries

Asia Asia-Pacific

Europe

Latin America

and

the Caribbean

Nth America



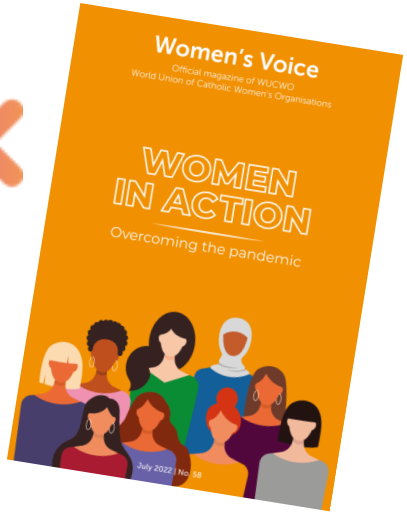
International Secretary

Liz Roche

cwlanz.wucwointnlsec@gmail.com

World Women's Observatory





The WUCWO logi depicts the following symbols:

The World: The place where the Christian acts and works so that the Evangelical values are lived: Peace, Justice, Solidarity, Mercy, Love.

The two hands of women, one white and another of color: The presence of the faith-filled woman contributing "Feminine Genius" to construct a more human world.

The dove with the olive branch: The peace that the world needs.

The Cross and the Crown: Jesus invites us to construct the Kingdom, bringing God to earth.



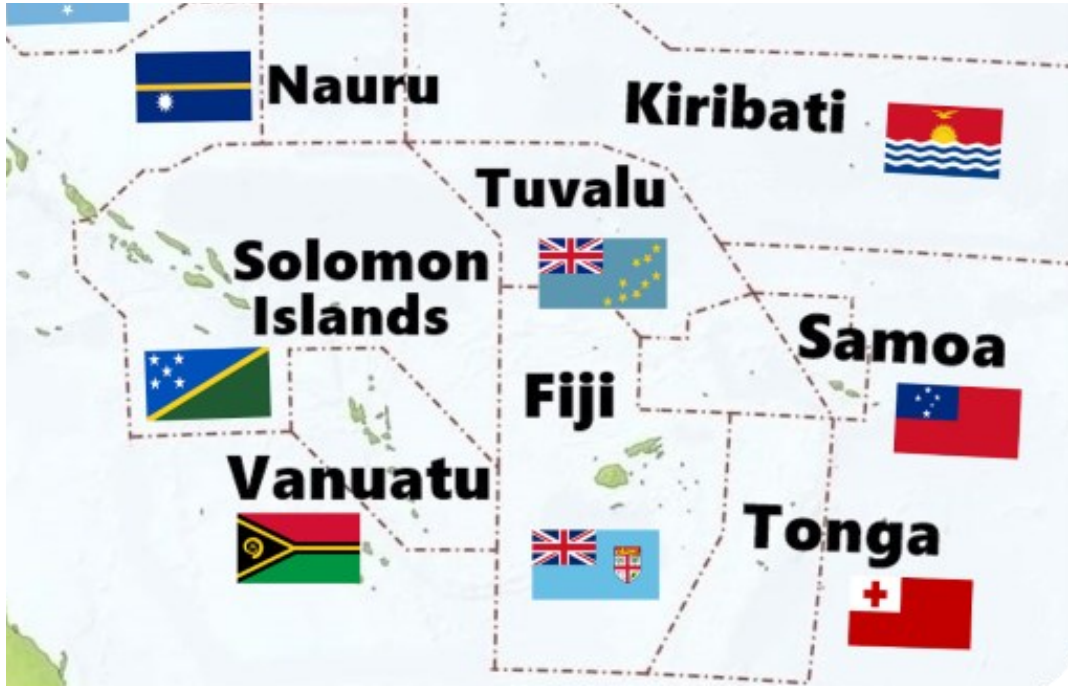


MISSIONS

From its foundations, the Bishops of Aotearoa-New Zealand requested CWL to support both the Maori Mission and the Church in the south-west Pacific. Thus missions at home and in the Pacific have always been considered the first beneficiary for fund-raising. Branches and regions are allocated specific mission communities to support with prayer, letters and fund-raising.

The National Mission Secretary oversees the allocation of mission com-munities, and works to ensure that League support is spread as widely and as equitably as possible.

Mission Communities supported by branches of CWLANZ are as follows -





National Mission Secretary

Joan Lawn

Contact Joan

cwlanz.nat.missionsecretary@gmail.com

NATHANIEL CENTRE (The NZ Catholic Bio-ethics Centre)

A body responsible for National Catholic Bio-ethics was set up by the Conference of New Zealand Bishops as a direct outcome of a request made by CWLANZ and Catholic doctors in the late 1980's. Meetings were held in Auckland, chaired by CWL's Barbara Wilkinson, the only non-medical person on the committee. With the support of CWLANZ, a centre named the Nathaniel Centre was finally opened in Wellington in May 1999. Making the principles and processes of bio-ethics understandable in terms of Catholic teaching is one of its primary tasks.

JOHN PAUL CENTRE

Dedicated to building a Culture of Life, Marriage and Family . Jp2.org.nz
Organizes the 'Mass for Life'

REGIONAL DAY RAFFLES



Money is given to the hosting branch each year to buy raffles to sell on region day, the amount is set each year by the hosting branch

WUCWO: (World Union of Catholic Women's Organisations)

A Donation is usually collected at the **WUCWO service** each year. Money is then forwarded from the Diocesan Treasurer to the National Treasurer, for the support of WUCWO's international work

Special Funds

NATIONAL MISSION PROJECT AND MISSION EDUCATION FUND

These two national funds support CWLANZ's mission work in the Pacific.

The amount raised annually for the **National Mission Project** is donated to a specific project in the Pacific Islands.
A different recipient is chosen each year.

The Mission Education Fund is ongoing and CWL branches may ask for a grant from it
for educational needs which branches themselves are unable to meet.

N.B. *Branches are expected to give an annual donation to each of these two funds.*
· Suggestions for an appropriate recipient are put forward each year by branches prior to the first meeting of the year
· Applications for grants from the Mission Education Fund may be made at any time.

JUBILEE FUND

In 1974, to mark twenty-five years since the establishment of the League, members raised a capital fund, known as the Silver Jubilee Fund. This was added to in the year 2000 and became the Golden Jubilee Fund. With the Diamond Jubilee the next Jubilee to be celebrated, it seems appropriate simply to refer to the 'Jubilee Fund'.
Each year 10% of the interest is added to the invested capital to offset inflation. The balance of the interest is donated annually to social and charitable projects in Aotearoa-New Zealand
At National Conference in 2006, it was resolved that, as the amount involved is small in comparison with that given to the Mission At Home Appeal, it should be **directed to a project with a Catholic connection.**

N.B. *Suggestions for an appropriate recipient are put forward each year by branches prior to the first meeting of the year.*

ANNUAL 'MISSION AT HOME' APPEAL

This appeal was instituted in 1990 as a means of extending the League's presence and work in the wider community.

The funds raised, either by direct donations from members or by special fund-raising, are donated to a different national, non government funded, non-church, charitable organization each year. It is preferable that they are chosen once only unless a different branch of the organization.

Members are encouraged to learn about the work done by the organization, which is usually very willing to provide a suitable speaker for local groups or send copies of its publicity material.

A cheque for the amount raised throughout the branches is formally presented to the recipient organization at the bi-ennial National Conference or the July Board meeting.

N.B. *Branches are expected to give an annual donation to this fund.*

· *Suggestions for an appropriate recipient are put forward each year by branches prior to the first meeting of the year.*

Where these are then collated, discussed and voted on by Board members.

Past recipients of the 'At Home' Appeal have been

2023 **Diabetes NZ - Youth Camps**
2022 **I am Hope**
2021 **Tourettes**
2020
2019
2018
2017
2016
2015
2014
2013
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2002
2001
2000
1999
1998
1997



Kate Sheppard's contribution to New Zealand's identity has been acknowledged on the $10 note and a commemorative stamp.



CAMELIA FUND

NCW: (National Council of Women)

Previously known as "Cents for May", Small amounts eg: 25 – 50cents per member. Assists with the National Council of Women (Christchurch) administration costs.



In 1993 on Kate Shepherd's birthday the white camelia flower became associated with Kate Shepherd and women's suffrage. At the time a camelia walkway and arch was established in the Botanical Gardens in Christchurch. It is the only National *Memorial* in Christchurch and is the only New Zealand *monument* depicting the fight for women's suffrage.

CWL are represented on the NCW committee.





130 year anniversary celebrations



FATHER LAW HOME FIJI

This home is in Fiji and the Catholic Women's League Christchurch Diocese (Region one only) support this home, proceeds from region day each year is forwarded to the home to support them.

FATHER LAW HOME

Father Law Home

1.5K likes · **1.7K** followers

Father Law Home provides shelter and comfort for elderly men and women who have nowhere to go.











Fiji's Forgotten Fathers



What is Father Law Home?

Father Law Home is one of nine currently operational aged-care facilities within Fiji that provide for 25 occupants, both male and female. Father Law Home ensures that all its residents receive consistent palliative, medical and custodial care. The primary consideration of the home - catering to the wellbeing and welfare of all residents - is the central, driving force of all operations. While the home is founded on the premises of Catholicism, supported by the Archdiocese of Suva, it is open to a diversity of religion and culture.

Father Law Home provides assisted living via warm, comfortable and secure facilities, three hot meals daily, aid in obtaining medical treatments and support on a personalized level. The home relies on a modest government grant and large amounts of public goodwill to keep the home operational.

Why Should You Donate?

Father Law Home relies on immense amounts of public goodwill in order to sustain its operations and provide its elderly residents with the quality of life, comfort and companionship that they deserve after being actively contributing members of Fijian society. Through your donations, the home is able to provide more medical support to residents in need, focus on facility maintenance, maintain and appropriately pay key staff and continue providing healthy, hot meals for these vulnerable residents.

In addition to this, your donations will provide Father Law Home with a source of comfort in regards to the consistent, up-coming bills that will allow it to worry less about money and more about putting a smile on our nations forgotten fathers. In the spirit of Father's Day, giving and kindness, be the change that is needed!

Make a difference in honor of the men who have shaped your life. Honor your father and father figures today by donating to our nation's often forgotten fathers!

FELLOWSHIP OF THE LEAST COIN

A collection during the year at each branch meeting of the smallest coin in our currency. Donations are taken each year on the first Friday in November to the service held by Church Women United. This money is distributed via a worldwide organisation helping women in poor countries become self sufficient and enable them to support their families. Members are encouraged to set aside the least coin in their country's currency (ex. penny, sentimo, paisa, etc.). Only the least coin is offered so that women of all backgrounds and means can be equal partners in justice- and peace- making.

These least coins are then collected by Christian women's groups
and ecumenical women's organizations in countries and regions
all over the world. They are then forwarded to the Fellowship of the
Least Coin (FLC) Fund, which is faithfully stewarded by the Inter
national Committee for the Fellowship of the Least Coin (ICFLC).



The logo includes 6 folded hands in prayer that encircle a small plum flower. The hands are different colours to represent people of all backgrounds.

Together, these praying hands form the image of a lotus flower.

The lotus plant grows in muddy ponds but its flower rises above the murky water and opens beautifully, without blemish. In the same spirit, although women and girls all over the world face oppression and injustices of many kinds, with prayer and support they, too, can rise above these circumstances with dignity and grace.

Fellowship of the Least Coin

Prayer

O loving Creator, we present ourselves in your divine presence to thank you for all the bountiful gifts of life. We are especially grateful for the Fellowship of the least coin. which binds us together in love and forgiveness around the globe. Free us from all doubts and prejudices, we pray. Inspire us to live in solidarity with humankind that we may know the joy of giving and receiving.

Dear God, accept the least coin ‘Token iof love; . Make us mindful of the miracles of these coins. Let us honour your creation with love, as shown through the life death and resurrection of your son Jesus the Christ . Amen



Organizations we support with recurring donations

Carmelite Sisters:

Donations are given to the sisters every year to help with the good works that the sister's do

The Sisters also have a shop for personal and Church needs

Website: christchurchcarmel.org

Address in Christchurch :
52 Halswell Road, Christchurch 8025.

Mass Times: 8.30 daily.

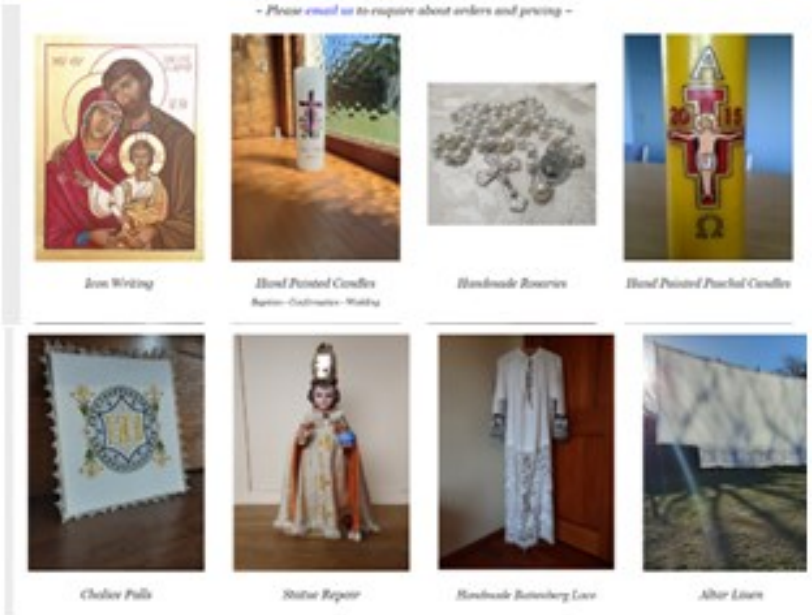
Parts of our coat of arms:

- The Seal of Mt. Carmel
- The Motto
- The Flaming Sword
- The Crown of Gold
- The Halo of Stars

Why have a coat of arms?

Just as nations, organizations, and individuals have their coats of arms, seal, or crest which are expressive of important facts in their history, or characteristics typical of them, so the order of Discalced Carmelites has its own crest, significant of its rich spirit and antiquity. Each part stands as a reminder of elements that make the Discalced Carmelite Order one of the most ancient, best established and ever beloved orders of the Roman Catholic Church.





CWLANZ Chaplaincy

Christine Paterson



CHAPLAIN TO THE NATIONAL BOARD

The Board may choose a suitable person, ordained or non-ordained, as Chaplain to the Board and ask the Conference of Bishops to confirm their choice.
chaplain's position, is in all matters, an advisory one.

DIOCESAN CHAPLAIN

A suitable person, ordained or non-ordained, may be appointed chaplain to the Diocesan Council. The Council may request the
Diocesan Bishop to confirm the appointment of a person of the Council's choice or of the Bishop's own choice.
The chaplain's position is, in all matters, an advisory one.

BRANCH CHAPLAIN

A suitable person, ordained or non-ordained, may be appointed chaplain to each branch of the League. The Branch Committee may request the Parish Priest / Pastoral Co-ordinator to confirm the appointment of a person of the Committee's choice or of the Parish Priest's / Pastoral Co-ordinator's own choice.
The chaplain's position is, in all matters, an advisory one.



National Council of Women

NCW Social Issues

Almost as soon as CWL groups were set up. Either as branches or dioceses, they affiliated to national Council of women of new Zealand as a means of making a Catholic voice heard in national concerns, particularly as they affect women and families. As a nationally organized society, CWLANZ is a member of the National Executive of CWLANZ. The national Social Issues Officer is responsible for bringing the League's concerns on social issues of national importance to the appropriate church or civil bodies.

Social Issues Officers are elected for the National Board, Diocese and branches.

CWLANZ National Social Issues Officer:

Bonnie Savage



Email: bonniesavage2@gmail.com

Welcome to CWLANZ

Information Page

Here you will find everything you need to know about us and what we do

Who we are

Our Stories

Our History

Our Faith - Our Service

Dear Members

Welcome to CWLANZ Information Page on Facebook

Here you will find everything you need to know about us and what we do; Who we are; Our Stories; Our History; Our Faith - Our Service; Our Resources etc.

It is sort of a mini website. As a resource page it will be non interactive, so no comments please. However it would be good if you hit 'like' when you look something up so that I can gauge what albumns are being used the most.

The page is divided into albumns for ease of use. At the top of the page there is a menu bar, At the end of this bar you will find 'albumns'. I have organized the page into albumns so that you can scroll across to there as soon as you open it and then click on the albumn you want to peruse. The idea is that if a question regarding CWL comes up at a meeting you will be find the answer very quickly.

This is only a start and I am sure there will be many things that you may like added to it. Please email me with your ideas. Just remember that is it simply for information of CWL affairs.

Could Diocesan Presidents please update your contact list and send them to me when you are able to so that they can be added.

Our member facebook page continues to be of great interest with lots of photos as to what you are all up to, This is great. Thank you all for your great posts and photos. Don't forget to look at the Newsroom page too.

This now means that we have four facebook pages. The beauty of these pages is that they are all free!! Three of the pages are private and just the one Public page.

I am still working on the website and progress is looking promising at this stage. Watch this space. The website is of course will be public. Costs need to be negotiated.

To find the page

Log into Facebook—Search CWL Information page—ask to join—I will confirm your request and you will be good to go.

“At Home” Appeal 2023

Each year CWLANZ decide on a non-government funded charitable organization in New Zealand to direct an appeal for their fund raising efforts. Branches are encouraged to engage speakers from the organization to speak at their meetings so that we can become more informed about it.

This year our at home appeal is DIABETES NZ, focusing on youth camps. Your support would be greatly appreciated Contact any branch of CWL. More information is available on -diabetes.org.nz

YOUTH AND WHAANAU CAMPS 2023

Kids and their whānau need to feel supported in their diabetes journey. Connecting up with others at our camps is a great way to meet new friends, create a support network and share and learn together.

Upcoming camps



HARMFUL COMMUNICATIONS POLICY
PRIVACY POLICY TERMS OF USE

diabetes new zealand



Live Brave Mana Ora



Living Brave Family Camp

diabetes new zealand

NZCYCN
New Zealand Child & Youth Clinical Network